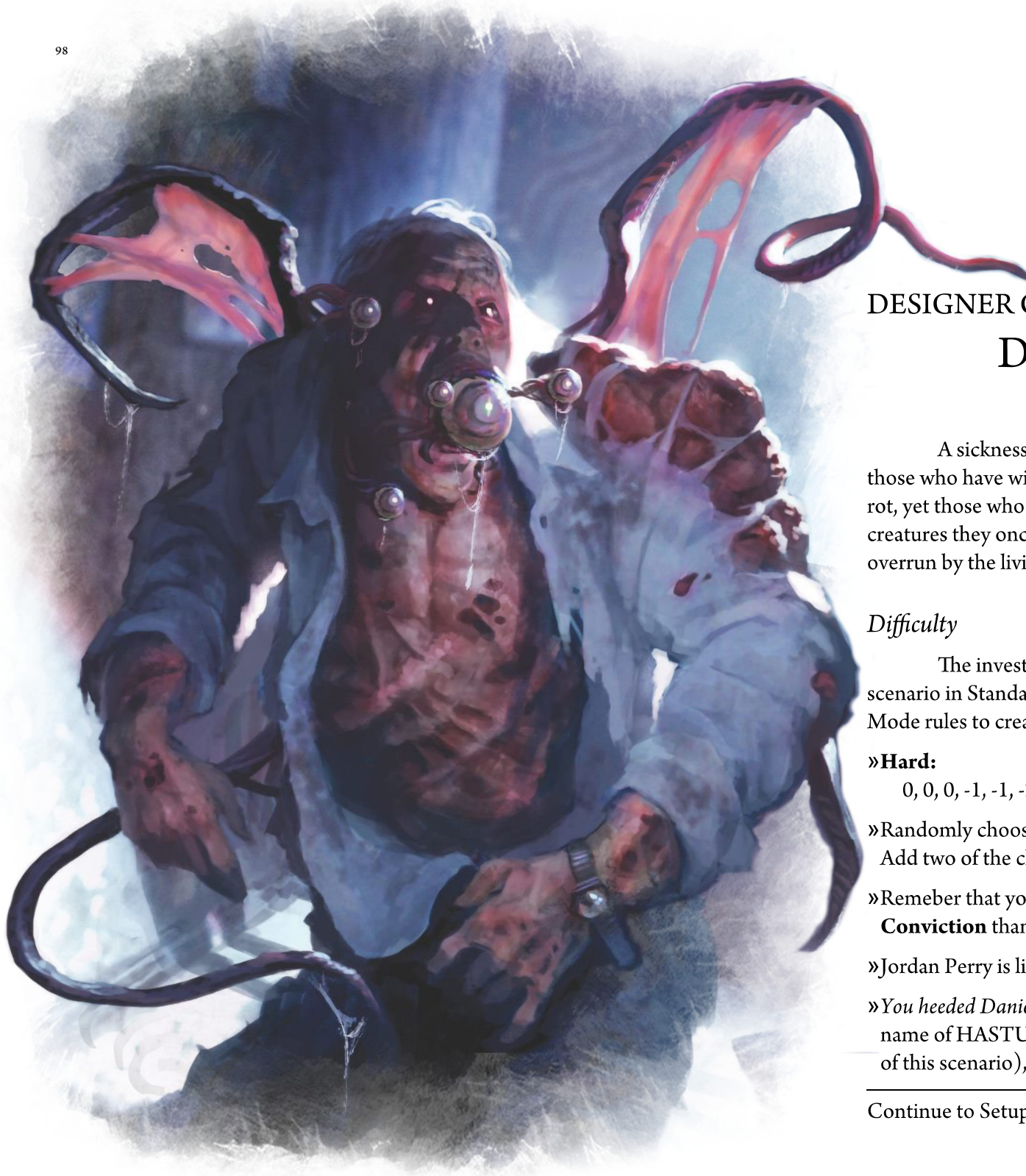




DESIGNER CHALLENGE

DEATH IN PARIS

A PHANTOM OF TRUTH

A sickness is spreading through Paris, a sickness borne by those who have witnessed the Yellow Sign. Flesh putrefies, bodies rot, yet those who have seen it live on, horrible parodies of the creatures they once were. Can you survive three nights in a city overrun by the living dead?

Difficulty

The investigators must play the "A Phantom of Truth" scenario in Standalone Mode on Hard difficulty. Use the Standalone Mode rules to create your investigator deck(s).

»Hard:

0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -5, ☠, ☠, ☠, ♠, ♠, ♠, ♠, ♠.

»Randomly choose one of the following tokens (♠, ♠, and ♠). Add two of the chosen token to the chaos bag.

»Remember that you have chosen **Conviction** and have more **Conviction** than **Doubt**.

»Jordan Perry is listed under "VIPs Slain."

»*You heeded Daniel's warning.* Any time an investigator speaks the name of HASTUR aloud during this scenario (or during the setup of this scenario), that investigator must immediately take 1 horror.

Continue to Setup on page 10.

Setup

»Gather all cards from the following encounter sets: *A Phantom of Truth*, *Evil Portents*, *The Stranger*, *Agents of Hastur*, and *The Midnight Masks*. These sets are indicated by the following icons:



When gathering *The Midnight Masks* encounter set, only gather the 5 treachery cards (2x False Lead and 3x Hunting Shadow). Do not gather the location, act, agenda, or scenario reference cards from that set.

- »Search the gathered encounter sets for both copies of Black Stars Rise and both copies of False Lead, and remove them from the game.
- »During this Scenario, use Act 1—The Parisian Conspiracy (v. II). The other version of Act 1 is removed from the game.

Ultimatum of the Coffin-Worm: In addition to the standard setup instructions for *A Phantom of Truth*, when gathering encounter sets, also gather the *Hastur's Gift* and *Cult of the Yellow Sign* encounter sets, and all three copies of the Corpse Dweller enemy from *The Pallid Mask* encounter set. These sets are indicated by the following icons:



After gathering encounter sets, remove the two copies of Stealthy Byakhee, and the two copies of Screeching Byakhee from the game.

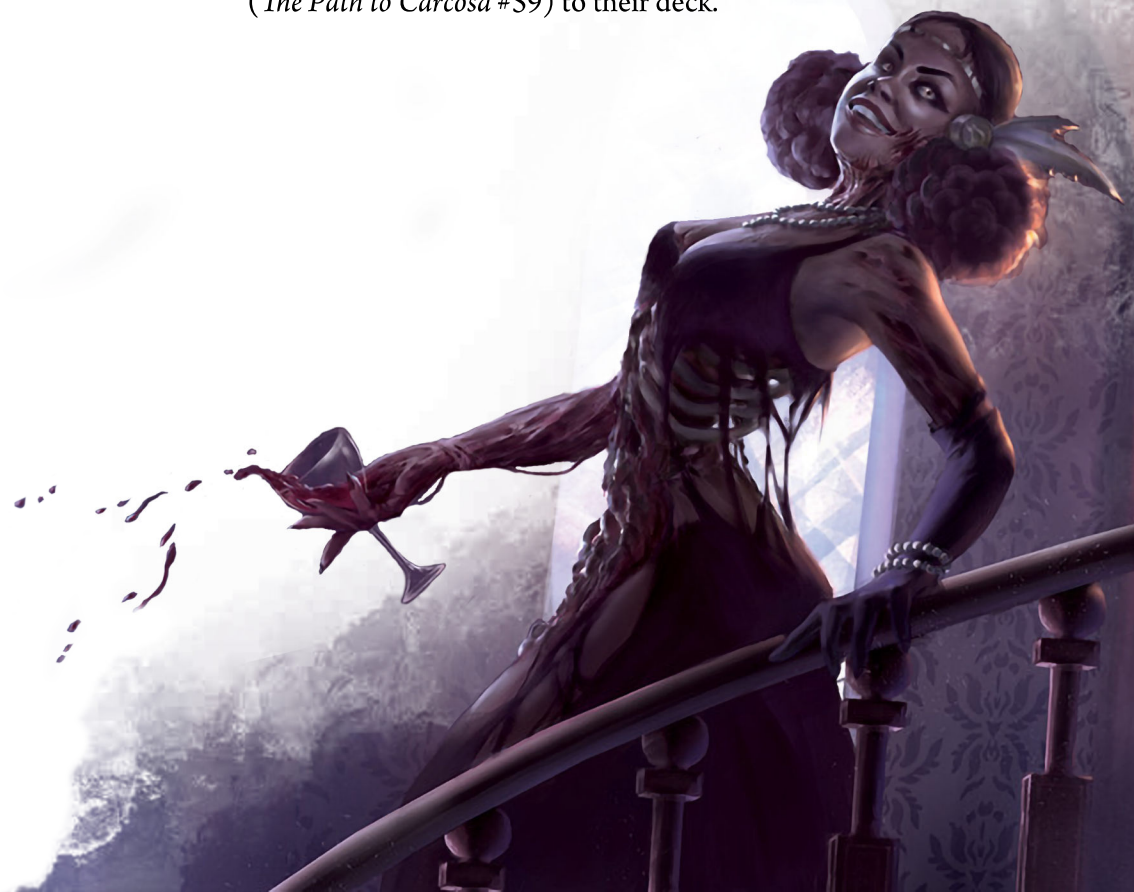
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Ultimatum of the Endless Party: Gather the five Sickening Reality story cards from *The Last King* encounter set. Set those cards aside. This set is indicated by the following icon.



During this scenario, after resolving the “b” side of any Act or Agenda, the lead investigator must choose one of the set-aside Sickening Reality cards at random and put it into play (enemy side faceup) at their location.

- »Set the double-sided The Organist enemy aside, out of play.
- »Do not take the Lost Soul weakness as instructed during this scenario's introduction.
- »The lead investigator adds The Man in the Pallid Mask weakness (*The Path to Carcosa* #59) to their deck.



» Choose one of the two Montmartre locations, one of the two Opéra Garnier locations, and one of the two Le Marais locations, at random. Put the chosen locations into play. Remove the other versions of those locations from the game.

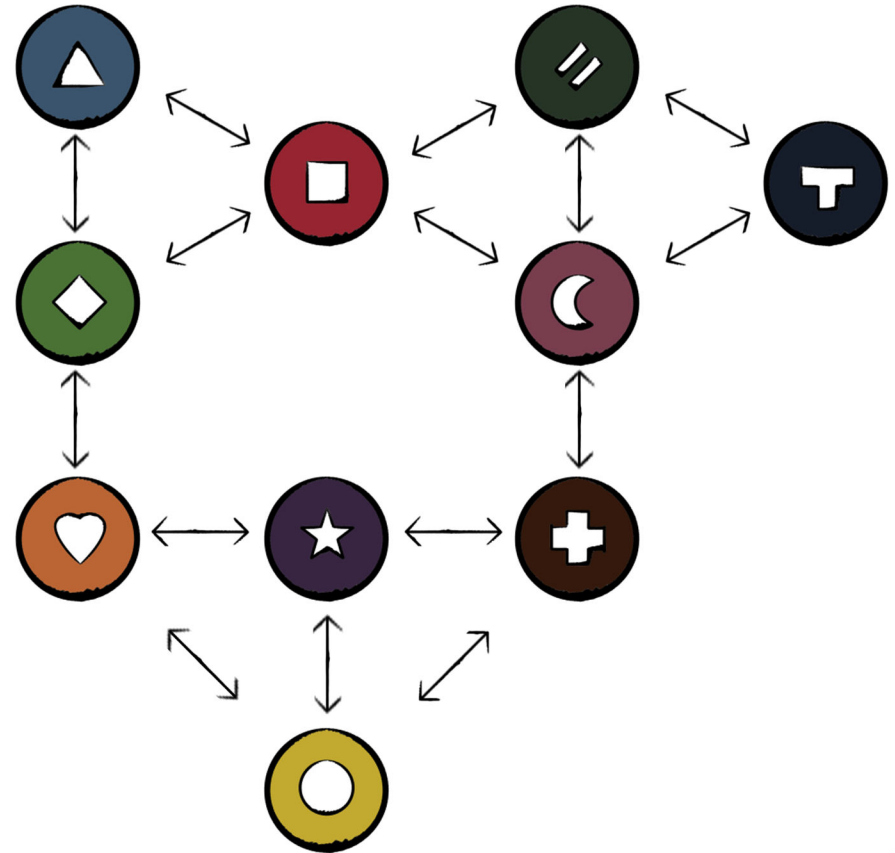
» Put the remaining locations (Montparnasse, Gare d'Orsay, Grand Guignol, Canal Saint-Martin, Père Lachaise Cemetery, Notre-Dame, and Gardens of Luxembourg) into play. (See below for suggested placement.) Each investigator begins play at Gare d'Orsay.

» Shuffle the remainder of the encounter cards to build the encounter deck.

Boon of the Child: Once per round, an investigator may play the topmost event in their discard pile as if it were in their hand. If they do, after that event resolves, they must place it on the bottom of their deck.



Suggested Location Placement



When the game is complete:

» If no resolution was reached (each investigator resigned or was defeated),

Go to page 104.

» If Resolution 1 was reached,

Go to page 106.



...from page 103 (*No Resolution*).

You lose track of yourself within the city as you flee for your life. Your feet move of their own accord. The beating of sinewy wings and screeching of creatures above you spurs you onward. Soon you find yourself running down a narrow avenue, passing a set of heavy iron gates. You are in a dead end—a court with tall, old houses on either side. You turn back toward the entrance to find the shapes of many winged creatures barring your path. They are perched on the gates and on the balconies above, awaiting your doom. Walking with cold, sinister confidence, the man in black opens the iron gate and enters the court. His face gleams in the darkness. His eyes pierce your soul. For a moment, you recognize him for what he truly is. It is the last you remember of that night.

»Record in your Campaign Log that *you did not escape the gaze of the phantom*.

»Each investigator earns experience equal to the Victory X value of each card in the victory display.

»The investigators lost the challenge scenario.



...from page 103 (Resolution 1).

You can only assume this house belongs to Nigel Engram, the director of The King in Yellow. At last, you have finally found your quarry ... and yet, it is little relief to your straining sanity. You feel like a dog being led by a leash, your fate decided by a cruel master who has long kept you in the dark. You push these gloomy thoughts to the back of your mind and knock on Mr. Engram's door. There is no response but a flock of magpies that scatter from the rooftop at the sudden noise. You try the doorknob, hoping you won't have to resort to more forceful measures. To your surprise, you find the door unlocked.

Inside, Nigel's home is a mess of notes, old books, and strange diagrams. Covering the coffee table in his living room is an old, faded map, bearing many fold creases and tattered edges. It looks to be an incomplete map of the catacombs beneath Paris, or at least a section of it. The food in his pantry is old and rotten. There is no sign of anyone having lived here for years, and yet the ink upon the living room walls is wet and fresh. Over and over, across nearly every inch of the wallpaper, it reads:

He is already here



»Record in your Campaign Log that *you found Nigel's home*.

»Each investigator earns experience equal to the Victory X value of each card in the victory display.

»The investigators won the challenge scenario!

